



KEYAN ZHANG

GAME DESIGNER

Systems, progression,
economy & live ops

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LinkedIn

SKILLS

System & level design
Economy balancing
Playtest analysis
Live operations
AI-assisted prototyping
Design workflow
automation
AI-assisted data analysis

TOOLS

Unity · Unreal
C# · C++
Maya · Substance Painter
Claude Code · Codex
Antigravity

LANGUAGES

Mandarin · English

EXPERIENCE

Game Designer | TapBlaze

Jul 2019–Present

Lead design responsibilities for **Good Pizza, Great Pizza** and **Good Coffee, Great Coffee**, across systems, content, and live operations.

- Design progression, challenge, and collection systems, connecting player goals with gameplay and interface requirements.
- Balance economies and event rewards through playtesting, player data, and collaborative design reviews.
- Guide **Homecraft** level balancing and difficulty progression; use gameplay metrics to inform tuning and feedback to designers.
- Investigate player retention and experiment results with AI-assisted analysis to inform design decisions.

Teaching Assistant — Game Design | NYU Game Center

Sep 2018–May 2019

- Prepared course materials on level design and economy balancing, delivered lectures, and reviewed student game projects.

Game Design Intern | NetEase Infinity Studio

Jun–Aug 2018

- Designed flow, rewards, weapons, and enemies for a daily co-op challenge mode; balanced gameplay through playtests and collaborated with programmers and artists.

SPEAKING & COMMUNITY

Speaker | Game Developers Conference 2025

Monetizing Through Game Art: Creating Engaging Decors in 'Good Pizza, Great Pizza'

Co-host | Worthy Opawntent (棋鼓相当)

Chinese-language board game channel on Bilibili, featuring discussion, reviews, rules teaching, playthroughs, and tournament commentary.

SELECTED PROJECT

OLU | NYU Game Center — MFA Thesis

Lead Game Designer & Producer. Designed puzzles for a Unity mobile game; documented and grayboxed levels and managed production priorities.

EDUCATION

New York University — MFA, Game Design | 2017–2019

UCLA — BS, Applied Mathematics | 2013–2017

Double minor: Statistics and Classical Civilization.